

Absolutely — **cheap** is a strong target because your passage uses it here:

> “That is **not exactly cheap**...”

Here **cheap** means **low in price / not expensive**, but the word also has important meanings involving **poor quality, stinginess, unfair/easy tactics, low-value emotion/effects, and low-cost availability**.

# Word family: **cheap / cheaply / cheapness**

**Base word:** cheap

**Adverb:** cheaply

**Noun:** cheapness

**Part of speech:** adjective ( 形容詞 )

Your source sentence:

> “That is **not exactly cheap**...”

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# Meaning in your passage: **cheap = low in price — 便宜的 ; 價格低的**

Here **cheap** means:

> **costing relatively little money compared with similar things or with what is expected.**

**繁體中文 :**

**價格相對較低、花費不多 ; 便宜的**

Natural translation:

> “That is not exactly cheap.”

「那可**不算便宜**。」

So here:

> **cheap = 價格低 / 花費少**

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# 1. **cheap = low-priced — 便宜的 ; 價格低的**

The core meaning.

### ### Practice 1 — Original

> “That is **not exactly cheap**.”

「那可**不算便宜**。」

### ### Practice 2

> “The museum shop sells some cheap postcards.”

「博物館商店有出售一些**便宜的明信片**。」

### ### Practice 3

> “We found a cheaper frame online.”

「我們在網上找到一個**更便宜的畫框**。」

**cheap = 相對於同類物品或預期而言，所需金錢較少**

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# 2. **cheap = inexpensive because it costs little — 低成本的；廉價的**

A broader practical sense.

### ### Practice 4

> “Digital copies are a **cheap** way to access art.”

「數碼複製品是一種**低成本 / 便宜**接觸藝術的方法。」

### ### Practice 5

> “They were looking for a cheap solution.”

「他們正在找一個**低成本的解決方法**。」

**cheap = 所需花費低，重點在成本少**

This does **not** automatically mean poor quality.

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# 3. **cheap = poor in quality / badly made — 廉價劣質的；粗製濫造的**

A major negative meaning.

#### ### Practice 6

> “The frame looked **cheap**.”

「那個畫框看起來很**廉價 / 質感很差**。」

#### ### Practice 7

> “The bag was made from cheap plastic.”

「那個袋是用**廉價劣質塑膠**製成的。」

**cheap** = 因材料、造工或外觀低劣而顯得沒有質感

Important:

Here **cheap** is about **quality/image**, not only price.

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# 4. **cheap-looking** = 看起來廉價的；沒有質感的

A very useful compound.

#### ### Practice 8

> “The gold-coloured frame looked **cheap-looking**.”

「那個金色畫框看起來很**廉價、沒有質感**。」

#### ### Practice 9

> “Bright plastic can make the product look cheap.”

「鮮亮的塑膠可能令產品看起來很**廉價**。」

**cheap-looking** = 外觀令人覺得品質低、造工差或沒有質感

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# 5. **cheap** = stingy / unwilling to spend money — 吝嗇的；小氣的

A major person-description meaning.

#### ### Practice 10

> “He is too **cheap** to pay for parking.”

「他太**小氣 / 吝嗇**，連泊車費都不願付。」

#### ### Practice 11

> “Don’t be cheap—leave a proper tip.”

「不要那麼**小氣**，留合理的小費吧。」

**cheap — person** = 過分不願花錢，即使合理支出也想避免

Register:

\* informal

\* often negative

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# 6. **cheap** = easy / unfair / unearned — 低級的；不光彩的；取巧的

A strong figurative meaning.

#### ### Practice 12

> “That was a **cheap trick**.”

「那是個**低級 / 不光彩的手段**。」

#### ### Practice 13

> “He scored a cheap victory because his opponent was injured.”

「他因對手受傷而取得一場**得來容易、含金量不高的勝利**。」

**cheap** = 不需要真正實力、努力或公平競爭便取得效果，因此顯得不光彩 / 沒有價值

Common:

\* cheap trick

\* cheap shot

\* cheap victory

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# 7. \*\*cheap shot = 刻薄攻擊；卑劣招數\*\*

A high-value fixed expression.

### Practice 14

> “That comment was a \*\*cheap shot\*\*.”

「那句話是一次\*\*刻薄 / 卑劣的攻擊\*\*。」

### Practice 15

> “Criticizing his family was a cheap shot.”

「批評他的家人是一種\*\*卑劣的攻擊手段\*\*。」

**\*\*cheap shot = 不公平、容易得手、通常針對弱點的攻擊或批評\*\***

This can be:

\* verbal

\* physical

\* rhetorical

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# 8. \*\*cheap trick = 低級手段；廉價伎倆\*\*

### Practice 16

> “Using fear to get attention is a \*\*cheap trick\*\*.”

「利用恐懼吸引注意是一種\*\*廉價伎倆 / 低級手段\*\*。」

### Practice 17

> “The advertisement relies on cheap tricks.”

「這則廣告依賴一些\*\*低級伎倆\*\*。」

**\*\*cheap trick = 容易操弄別人、缺乏真正技巧或品味的手段\*\***

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# 9. \*\*cheap = lacking depth/sincerity/value — 廉價的；膚淺的\*\*

A figurative evaluative sense.

#### ### Practice 18

> “The film relies on \*\*cheap emotion\*\*.”

「這部電影依賴\*\*廉價、刻意煽情的情緒效果\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 19

> “The speech was full of cheap sentiment.”

「這篇演說充滿\*\*廉價煽情\*\*。」

**\*\*cheap = 為了快速製造效果而顯得膚淺、做作、缺乏真正價值\*\***

Common in:

- \* cheap emotion
- \* cheap sentiment
- \* cheap humour
- \* cheap effect

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# 10. **\*\*cheap = easy to obtain / abundant at low cost — 低廉的；容易取得的\*\***

A broader economic sense.

#### ### Practice 20

> “Cheap energy helped the industry expand.”

「**\*\*低廉的能源\*\***幫助產業擴張。」

#### ### Practice 21

> “The company depends on cheap labour.”

「這家公司依賴**\*\*低成本勞工\*\***。」

**\*\*cheap = 某種資源、勞動力或服務的取得成本低\*\***

In some contexts, this can carry social/economic implications.

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# 11. \*\*cheap labour = 廉價勞工；低成本勞動力\*\*

#### ### Practice 22

> “The factory relied on \*\*cheap labour\*\*.”

「工廠依賴\*\*廉價勞工 / 低成本勞動力\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 23

> “Cheap labour can reduce production costs.”

「\*\*低成本勞動力\*\*可以降低生產成本。」

\*\*cheap labour = 工資成本相對低的勞動力\*\*

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# 12. \*\*cheap money ( 金融 ) — 低成本資金；低利率資金\*\*

A useful finance extension.

#### ### Practice 24

> “Businesses expanded during a period of \*\*cheap money\*\*.”

「企業在\*\*低利率資金充裕\*\*的時期擴張。」

#### ### Practice 25

> “Cheap money encouraged borrowing.”

「\*\*低成本借貸資金\*\*鼓勵了借款。」

\*\*cheap money = 借貸成本低、利率低的資金環境\*\*

Register: finance/economics.

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# 13. \*\*cheaply = at a low price — 便宜地；低價地\*\*

#### ### Practice 26

> “The prints can be produced \*\*cheaply\*\*.”

「這些印刷品可以\*\*低成本地\*\*製作。」

#### ### Practice 27

> “We bought the frame cheaply online.”

「我們在網上\*\*便宜地 / 低價\*\*買到那個畫框。」

**\*\*cheaply = 以較低價格 / 成本\*\***

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# 14. **\*\*cheaply = in a low-quality / tacky way — 廉價地；沒有質感地\*\***

#### ### Practice 28

> “The room was cheaply decorated.”

「房間佈置得很\*\*廉價、沒有質感\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 29

> “The product was cheaply made.”

「這件產品做得很\*\*粗糙 / 廉價\*\*。」

**\*\*cheaply = 以低成本、低質素或缺乏質感的方式\*\***

Context decides whether it means simply “low-cost” or negatively “poorly made”.

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# 15. **\*\*cheapness = low price — 便宜；低價\*\***

#### ### Practice 30

> “The main attraction is its **\*\*cheapness\*\***.”

「它最大的吸引力是\*\*價格便宜\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 31

> “Cheapness alone does not guarantee value.”

「單靠\*\*便宜\*\*並不代表有價值。」

**\*\*cheapness = 價格低廉這種特質\*\***

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# 16. **\*\*cheapness = poor/tacky quality — 廉價感；低質感\*\***

### Practice 32

> “The shiny plastic gave the product a sense of **\*\*cheapness\*\***.”

「亮面塑膠令產品帶有一種**\*\*廉價感\*\***。」

### Practice 33

> “The design avoided visual cheapness.”

「這個設計避免了視覺上的**\*\*廉價感\*\***。」

**\*\*cheapness = 外觀、造工或效果給人低質素 / 沒品味的感覺\*\***

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# Important distinction: **\*\*cheap vs inexpensive\*\***

This is one of the biggest learner contrasts.

### **\*\*inexpensive\*\***

= low in price, usually neutral/positive.

### **\*\*cheap\*\***

= low in price, but can also imply poor quality.

> inexpensive frame

> = 價格相宜的畫框

> cheap frame

> = 便宜畫框，亦可能讓人聯想到質素差

If you want to avoid negative connotation:

> **\*\*inexpensive\*\*** is safer.

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# Important distinction: **cheap vs affordable**

You just curated **afford**.

### **cheap**

= price itself is low.

### **affordable**

= price is within someone's ability to pay.

A thing can be:

> expensive but affordable to a wealthy buyer

or:

> cheap but still unaffordable to someone with very little money.

So:

> cheap = 價格低

> affordable = 負擔得起

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# Important distinction: **cheap vs low-cost**

### **cheap**

general, conversational, sometimes negative.

### **low-cost**

more neutral/business-like.

> cheap airline

> can sound evaluative.

> low-cost airline

> = 廉價航空 / 低成本航空

So **low-cost** is often safer in commercial contexts.

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# Important distinction: **cheap** vs **low-quality**

### **cheap**

may mean low price OR poor quality.

### **low-quality**

specifically means poor quality.

> “It’s cheap.”

could mean:

- \* 價格便宜
- \* 看起來很廉價

> “It’s low-quality.”

means:

- \* 質素差

Context is crucial.

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# Important distinction: **cheap** vs **poor**

### **cheap**

can refer to low price, low quality, or stinginess.

### **poor**

can mean bad quality, weak performance, or lacking money.

> cheap material

> = 廉價材料

> poor-quality material

> = 劣質材料

Not interchangeable in all contexts.

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# Important distinction: **cheap vs stingy**

### **cheap**

informal:

can describe a person unwilling to spend.

### **stingy**

more directly means:

unwilling to give/spend/share.

> “He’s cheap.”

= 他很小氣。

> “He’s stingy.”

= 他很吝嗇。

**Stingy** is more explicitly about character.

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# Important distinction: **cheap vs economical**

### **economical**

= uses money/resources efficiently.

### **cheap**

= low in price.

> cheap car

> = 車價低

> economical car

> = 使用 / 維修成本低，省油

Not the same.

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# Important distinction: **cheap vs cost-effective**

You already curated **cost-effective** under *cost*.

### **cheap**

= low price.

### **cost-effective**

= good result relative to cost.

A cheap solution can be ineffective.

A more expensive solution can still be more cost-effective.

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# Important distinction: **cheap-looking vs cheap**

### **cheap**

can state actual low price.

### **cheap-looking**

only describes appearance.

> cheap-looking watch

> = 看起來廉價的手錶

It may actually be expensive.

Very important nuance.

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# Important distinction: **not exactly cheap**

Your source phrase deserves special attention.

> “That is **not exactly cheap**.”

This is an understated way of saying:

> **it is fairly expensive**

It does **not** merely mean:

> “not very cheap.”

Natural Chinese:

> **「那可不算便宜。」**

> **「那其實相當貴。」**

This is a pragmatic understatement.

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# Important distinction: **cheap price**

Learner warning:

Native English more naturally says:

> **low price** ✓

> **cheap product** ✓

rather than:

> **cheap price** ⚠

because **cheap** usually describes the thing being sold, while **low** describes the numerical price.

Better:

> “The painting is cheap.”

> “The price is low.”

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# Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

\* **cheap — low price** = 便宜的

\* **cheap — low-cost** = 成本低的

\* **cheap — poor quality** = 廉價劣質的

\* **cheap-looking** = 看起來廉價的

\* \*\*cheap — stingy person\*\* = 小氣 / 吝嗇  
 \* \*\*cheap — unfair/easy tactic\*\* = 低級 / 不光彩的  
 \* \*\*cheap shot\*\* = 刻薄 / 卑劣攻擊  
 \* \*\*cheap trick\*\* = 廉價伎倆 / 低級手段  
 \* \*\*cheap — shallow effect/emotion\*\* = 膚淺 / 廉價的  
 \* \*\*cheap labour\*\* = 廉價勞工 / 低成本勞動力  
 \* \*\*cheap money\*\* = 低成本資金 / 低利率資金  
 \* \*\*cheaply — low price\*\* = 低價地  
 \* \*\*cheaply — poor quality\*\* = 廉價地 / 粗糙地  
 \* \*\*cheapness — price\*\* = 低價 / 便宜  
 \* \*\*cheapness — quality impression\*\* = 廉價感

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## # Master comparison

| Form / sense               | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                      | -----                                 |
| **cheap — price**          | 相對同類物品或預期而言，所需金錢較少                    |
| **cheap — low-cost**       | 完成、取得或生產某事所需成本較低                      |
| **cheap — poor quality**   | 因材料、造工或外觀低劣而顯得沒有質感                    |
| **cheap-looking**          | 外觀看起來品質低、造工差或沒有質感                     |
| **cheap — person**         | 過分不願花錢，即使合理支出也想避免；小氣                  |
| **cheap — tactic**         | 不靠真正實力或公平方式便取得效果，因此顯得低級 / 不光彩         |
| **cheap shot**             | 不公平、針對弱點的攻擊或批評                        |
| **cheap trick**            | 缺乏真正技巧、靠簡單操弄取得效果的手段                   |
| **cheap — emotion/effect** | 為快速製造反應而顯得膚淺、做作、缺乏真正價值                |
| **cheap labour**           | 工資成本相對較低的勞動力                          |
| **cheap money**            | 借貸成本低、利率較低的資金                         |
| **cheaply — price**        | 以較低價格 / 成本                            |
| **cheaply — quality**      | 以低質素、粗糙或缺乏質感的方式                       |
| **cheapness — price**      | 價格低廉這種特質                              |
| **cheapness — quality**    | 外觀或造工帶來的低質感 / 廉價感                     |

## # For your original sentence

> “That is **not exactly cheap**, but for a piece I would look at every day, I think it would be worth it.”

The exact meaning is:

**cheap** = 價格低；**not exactly cheap** 是委婉地表示「其實頗貴 / 不算便宜」

Natural translation:

> **「那當然不算便宜，但如果是一件我每天都會看的作品，我覺得還是值得。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **cheap ticket** → 便宜門票
- > **cheap material** → 廉價 / 劣質材料
- > **cheap-looking frame** → 看起來廉價的畫框
- > **cheap person** → 小氣的人
- > **cheap trick** → 低級手段
- > **cheap shot** → 卑劣 / 刻薄攻擊
- > **cheap labour** → 低成本勞動力
- > **cheap vs inexpensive** → 便宜且可能帶負面語感 vs 中性「價格不高」
- > **cheap vs affordable** → 價格低 vs 負擔得起
- > **not exactly cheap** → 不算便宜 / 其實頗貴